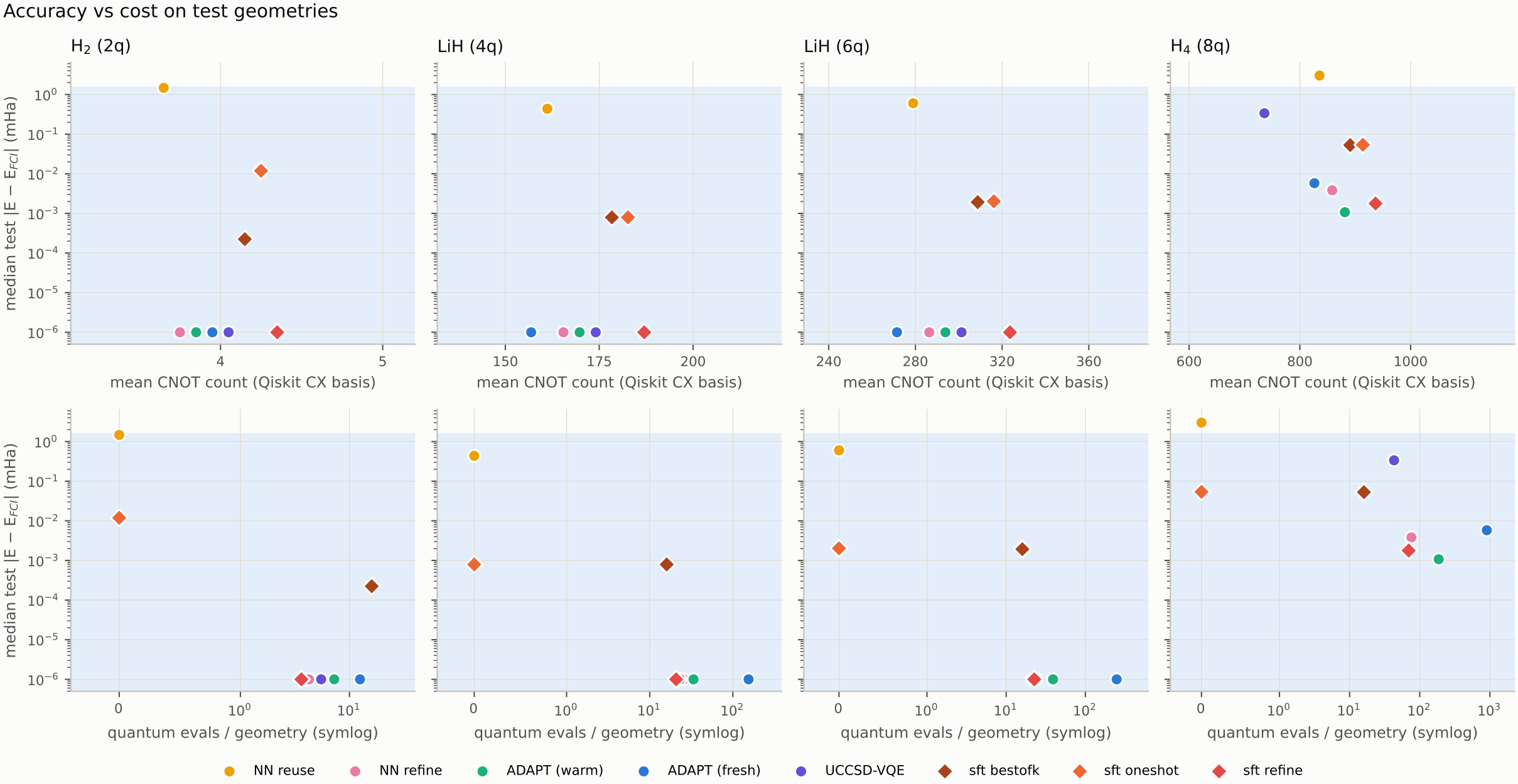

Top: circuit cost (CX count, horizontally dodged where methods share a circuit size). Bottom: quantum evaluations = energy + pool-gradient evaluations per test geometry. Shaded: below 1.6 mHa; medians < 1e-06 mHa drawn at 1e-06.